



Local Music Organizer

Detailed User Guide - Version 1.0

For large offline Music.app libraries, difficult audio formats and careful maintenance.

macOS 14 or later | Apple Silicon and Intel | Built-in offline audio engines

Contents

1. Why the application exists
2. Safety model and first launch
3. Important: warm the cache before large-library work
4. Cache types, timing and refresh rules
5. Navigation, playback and preview controls
6. Detailed guide to every main function
7. Repair / Convert, specialist formats and CUE albums
8. Vinyl De-click workflow
9. Troubleshooting
10. Privacy, open source and support

The illustrated section uses current release screenshots. Interface wording may change slightly in later updates.

Why Local Music Organizer exists

Local Music Organizer was not invented as a generic software product. It began as a personal solution written by a music collector and Music.app user with a very large offline library accumulated over many years.

The collection eventually became difficult to control: duplicate records, repeated playlist entries, missing artwork, inconsistent tags, broken file references, multiple versions of albums, rare releases and formats spread across folders and disks. Manual checking was too slow, and separate utilities showed only fragments of the problem.

The creator needed one place to answer practical questions before changing anything: Which file is better? Where is this track used? Is this a duplicate record or a second physical file? What is missing? What can be cleaned without losing the original?

Conversion created the same frustration. No single converter handled every difficult source in the collection. TAK, SACD ISO, DSD, DTS, AC3, CUE albums, tracker modules and other archival formats could require several tools and a fragile sequence of actions.

Local Music Organizer brought order back to that real collection and solved problems that had accumulated for years. Only after it worked as a personal tool did the creator decide it might be useful to other people who also maintain serious offline music libraries.

The result is intentionally cautious: understand first, review second, act only when the user explicitly chooses to act.

Safety model and first launch

On first launch, read the safety guidance and click Continue. macOS requests Automation permission when the application first needs to communicate with Music.app.

Music.app Automation

- Required for playlist and library reading.
- Required for Play in Music, playlist creation, supported tag changes and playlist-entry removal.
- Can be reviewed later in System Settings > Privacy & Security > Automation.

Files and folders

- Choose source files, search roots and output folders through macOS system pickers.
- The application remembers selected folders using security-scoped bookmarks.
- If a disk, folder or mount point changes, choose it again.
- Full Disk Access is not required.

Before making changes

- Keep a current backup of the Music.app library and important audio files.
- Begin with read-only tools such as Dashboard, Health Check, Artwork Check and Audio Inspector.
- Review duplicate candidates and playlist usage before removal.
- Test converted files before replacing anything in a personal archive.

Important: warm the cache first

For a large Music.app library, cache warm-up should be the first major operation after Refresh Playlists.

The first warm-up can take a long time. Music.app may need to return thousands of records and the contents of many playlists. Slow progress during this first pass does not mean that the application is stuck. The application is preparing reusable information so later tools do not have to ask Music.app for the same data repeatedly.

Let the first warm-up finish.

Recommended workflow

- Click Refresh Playlists.
- In Setup, enable saved cache restoration if the completed cache should be reused after relaunch.
- Run Warm Cache.
- Enable Include playlist usage when File Search, Track Usage and playlist labels are important.
- Wait until full records and playlist usage show Ready.
- Then run Dashboard, Library Map, duplicates, comparisons and searches.

What becomes faster

- Library Dashboard and library-wide analysis.
- Library Map and duplicate review.
- Playlist Compare and Playlist Duplicates.
- Track Usage and File Search playlist labels.
- Quality Duplicates and other repeated matching operations.

Repair / Convert works directly with selected files. It does not require the Music.app cache.

Cache types, timing and refresh rules

Full Library Records Cache

Stores the Music.app records used by library-wide dashboards, library duplicate work, quality checks and fast record searches.

Playlist Usage Cache

Stores playlist memberships used by Playlist Compare, Playlist Duplicates, Track Usage, File Search labels and usage protection before cleanup.

Saved cache between launches

When enabled, a completed cache can be restored after relaunch. This avoids repeating the entire warm-up every time. Restored data is fast, but it reflects the library state from the time it was saved.

When to clear and warm again

- After substantial playlist or library changes made directly in Music.app.
- After replacing many files or moving a library to another disk.
- When results appear older than the current Music.app library.
- After an application update only when the release notes specifically request it.

Do not clear a healthy cache before every operation. The purpose of the cache is to avoid repeated expensive Music.app reads.

Navigation, playback and previews

Play in Music

Opens Music.app and selects or plays the matching Music.app record. In File Search, choose the bright-blue playlist button to open the requested playlist and reveal the corresponding track. A file can belong to several playlists, so each playlist button is a separate destination.

Local Preview

Plays a physical file directly when you need to inspect the file without creating another Music.app record.

Finder and Quick Look

Reveal in Finder locates the physical file. Finder Preview or Quick Look is useful for checking a candidate independently of Music.app.

Stop

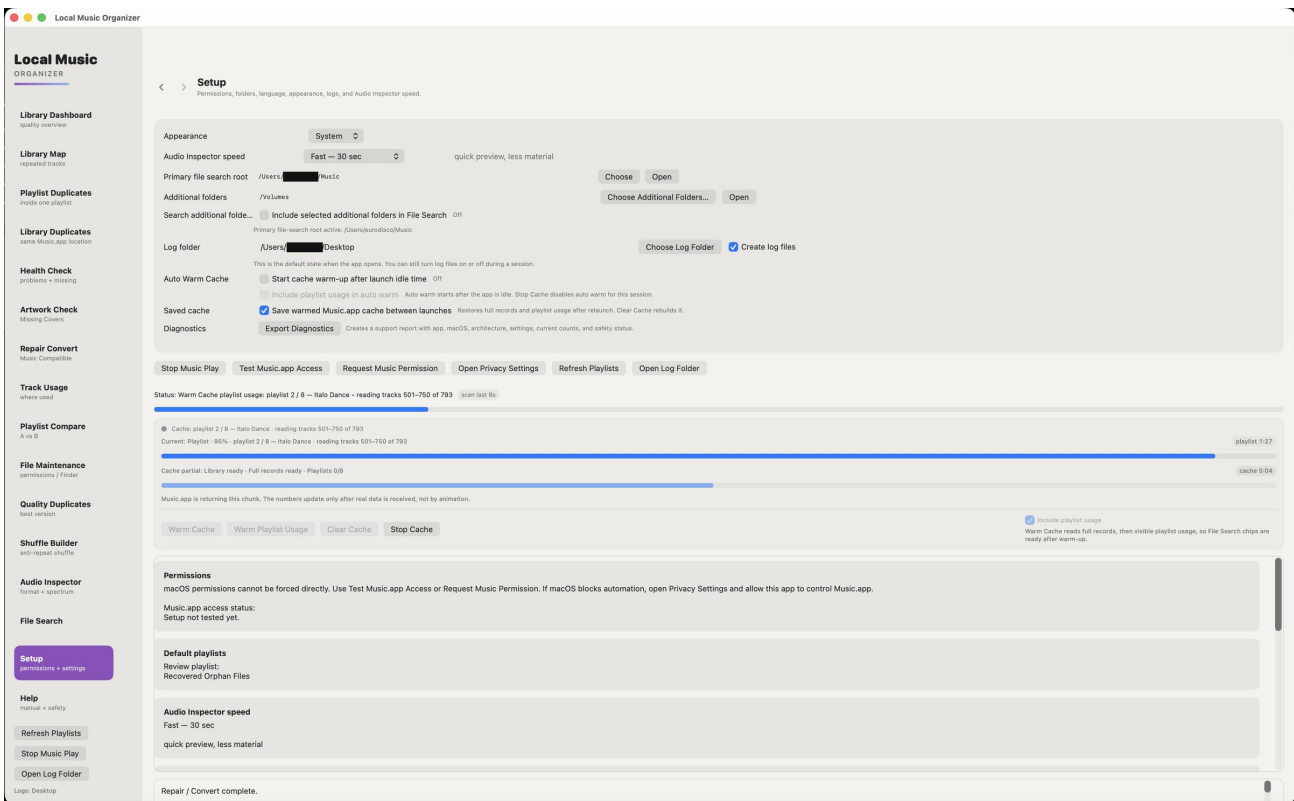
Stops Music.app playback, local preview and supported active conversion/de-click playback. A long Music.app request may finish its current step before the cache operation fully stops.

Back and Forward

Use the application navigation controls to return to the tool that opened Audio Inspector or another detail view.

Setup and permissions

Setup is the control center for playlist refresh, cache behavior, file-search roots, logs and saved folder access.

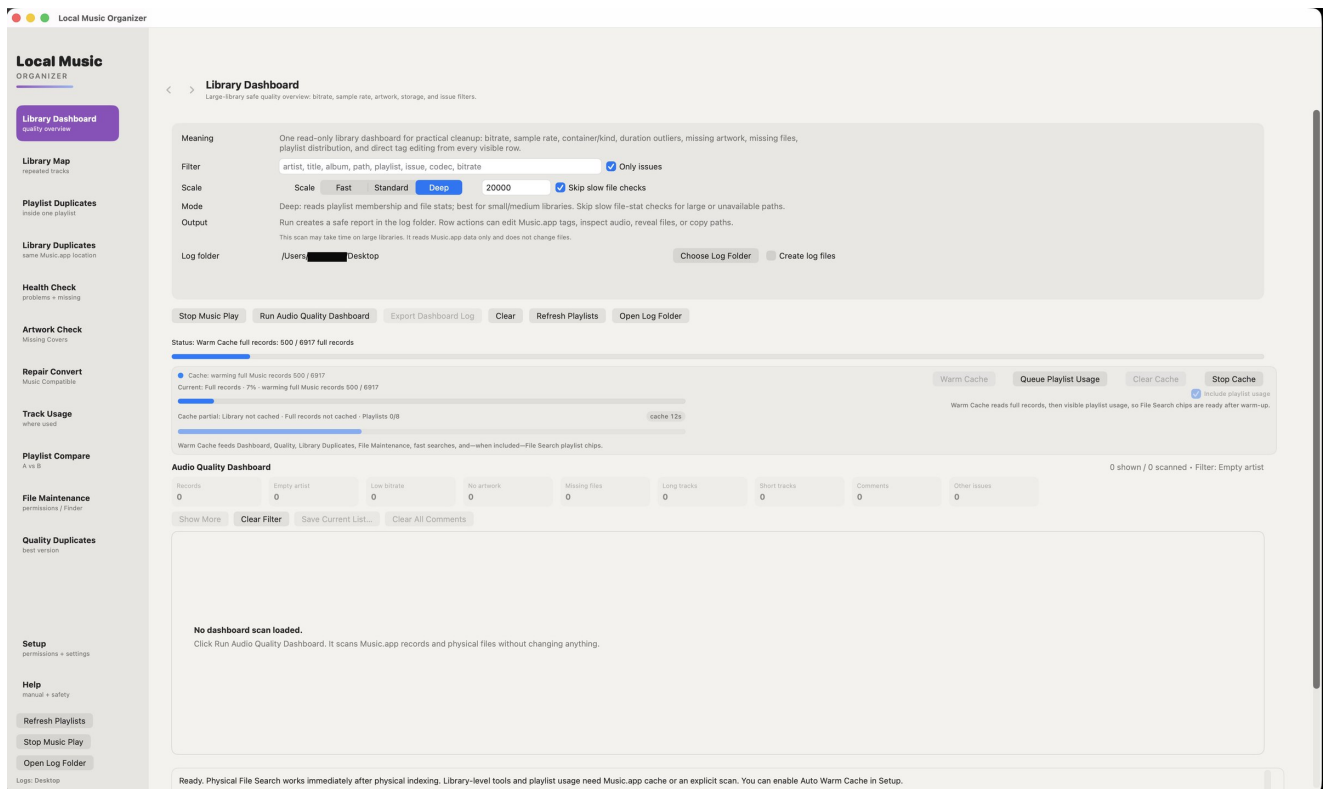


How to use this section

- Refresh playlists before warming the cache.
- Choose file-search roots and log locations with system pickers.
- Enable saved cache restoration for large libraries.
- Use Include playlist usage when playlist labels and usage protection are needed.

Library Dashboard

A read-only overview of the Music.app library.



How to use this section

- Warm the Full Library Records Cache first.
- Choose the intended scan depth and file-check behavior.
- Use Dashboard to identify missing files, artwork, low-bitrate records, long tracks and unusual metadata.
- Dashboard does not clean or delete anything.

Dashboard results

Results can be filtered so a large report remains manageable.

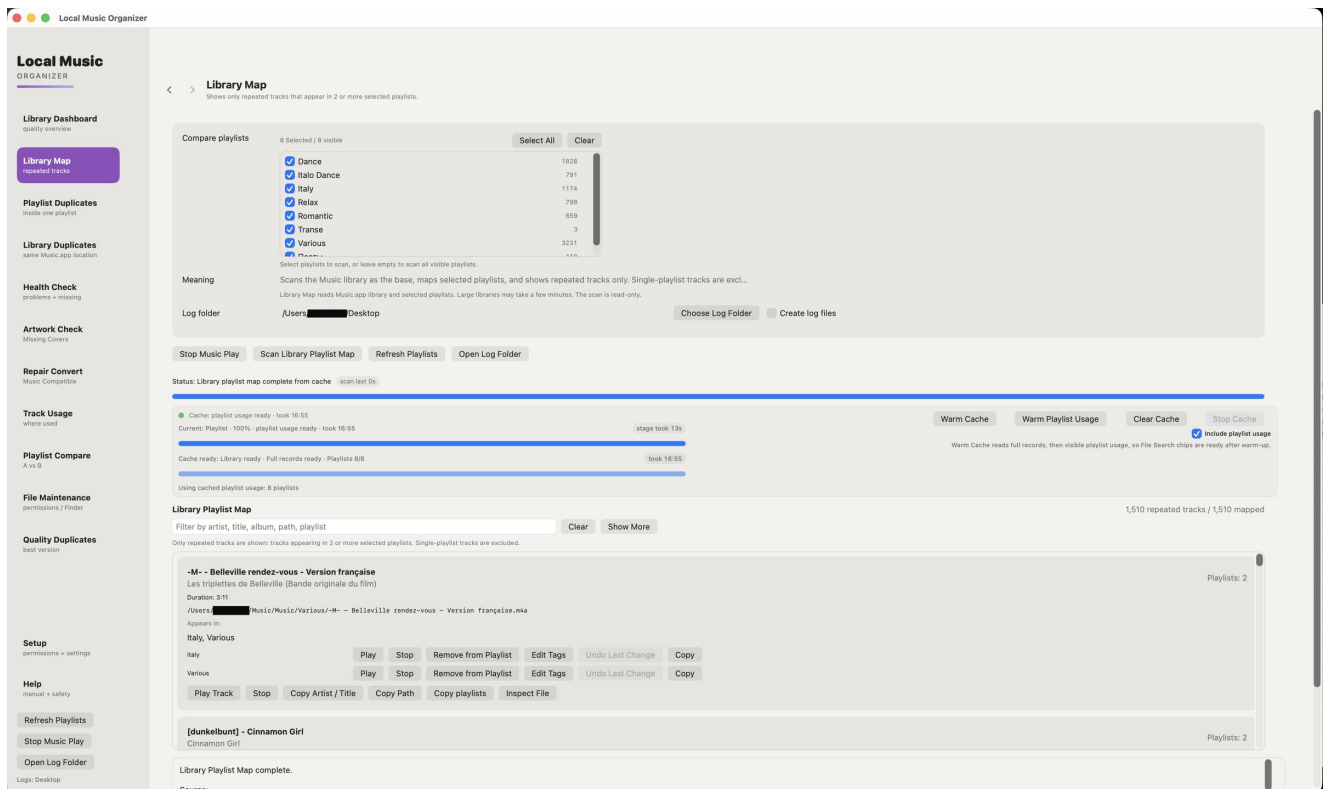
The screenshot displays the 'Library Dashboard' in the Local Music Organizer application. The interface includes a sidebar with navigation options like 'Library Dashboard', 'Library Map', 'Playlist Duplicates', 'Library Duplicates', 'Health Check', 'Artwork Check', 'Repair Convert', 'Track Usage', 'Playlist Compare', 'File Maintenance', 'Quality Duplicates', 'Setup', and 'Help'. The main content area shows the 'Library Dashboard' with a 'Scale' dropdown set to 'Deep' and a '20000' value. Below this, there are buttons for 'Stop Music Play', 'Run Audio Quality Dashboard', 'Export Dashboard Log', 'Clear', 'Refresh Playlists', and 'Open Log Folder'. A status bar indicates 'Audio Quality Dashboard complete' with a 'scan last 0s' timestamp. A progress bar shows 'Cache: playlist usage ready - took 16:55' and 'Current: Playlist - 100% - playlist usage ready - took 16:55'. Below the progress bar, there are buttons for 'Warm Cache', 'Warm Playlist Usage', 'Clear Cache', and 'Stop Cache'. A table of results shows 'Records: 6917', 'Empty artist: 0', 'Low bitrate: 14', 'No artwork: 1', 'Missing files: 0', 'Long tracks: 0', 'Short tracks: 0', 'Comments: 0', and 'Other issues: 0'. Two specific records are highlighted: 'Sonidero Nacional - Grande De Caderas (Tributo A Bronco)' and 'Tabitha Kermorant - Прекрасное далёко'. Each record shows file details like 'MP3 audio file - 128 kbps - 44100 Hz - 4:56 - 4.8 MB' and 'Storage: Local'. The dashboard also includes a 'Show More', 'Clear Filter', 'Save Current List...', and 'Clear All Comments' section.

How to use this section

- Treat counters as review signals, not automatic cleanup instructions.
- Open a record in Audio Inspector when technical confirmation is needed.
- Use Reveal or Play in Music to compare database information with the physical file.
- Refresh the cache when the displayed library state is no longer current.

Library Map

Shows repeated track usage across selected playlists.

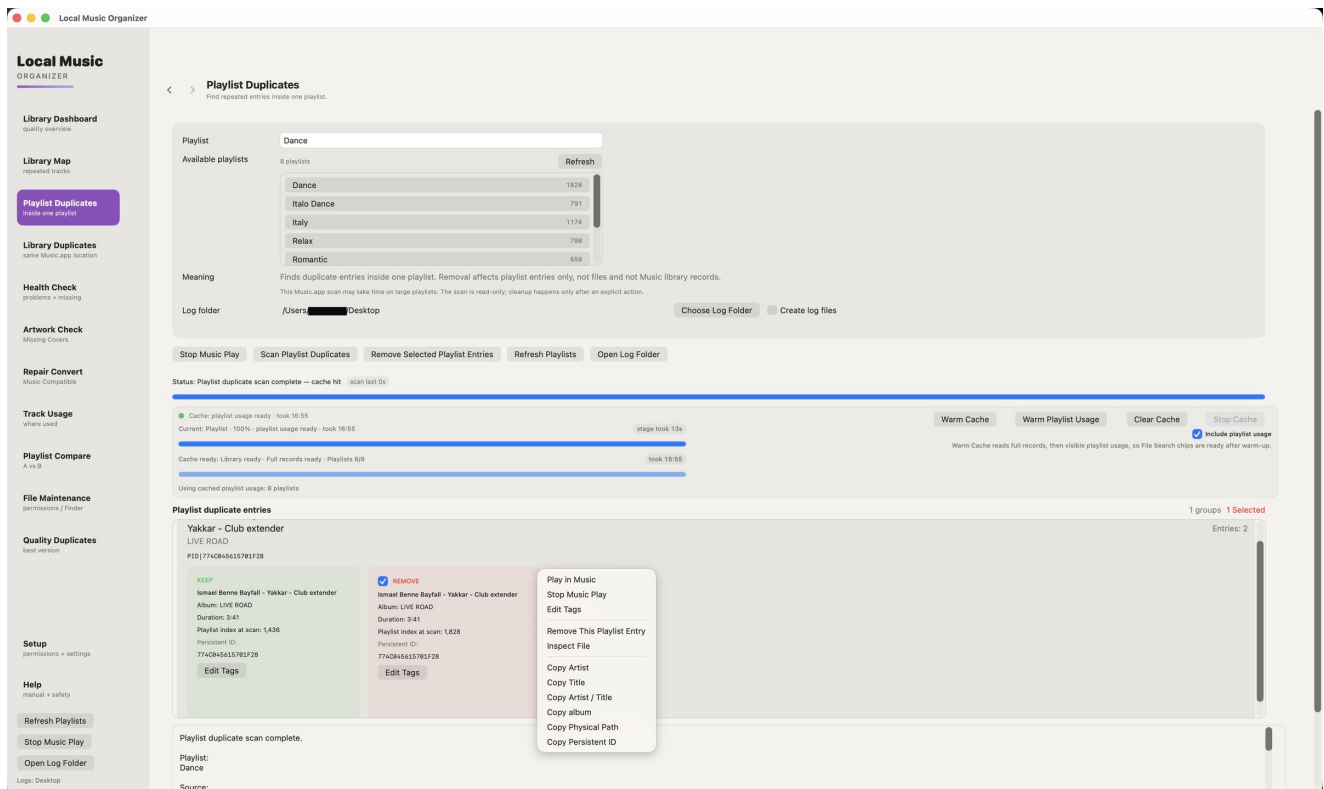


How to use this section

- Warm playlist usage before running the map.
- Use it to understand relationships, not to find repeated entries inside a single playlist.
- Review every playlist location before removing an entry.
- Playlist removal does not delete the audio file.

Playlist Duplicates

Finds repeated entries inside one chosen playlist.

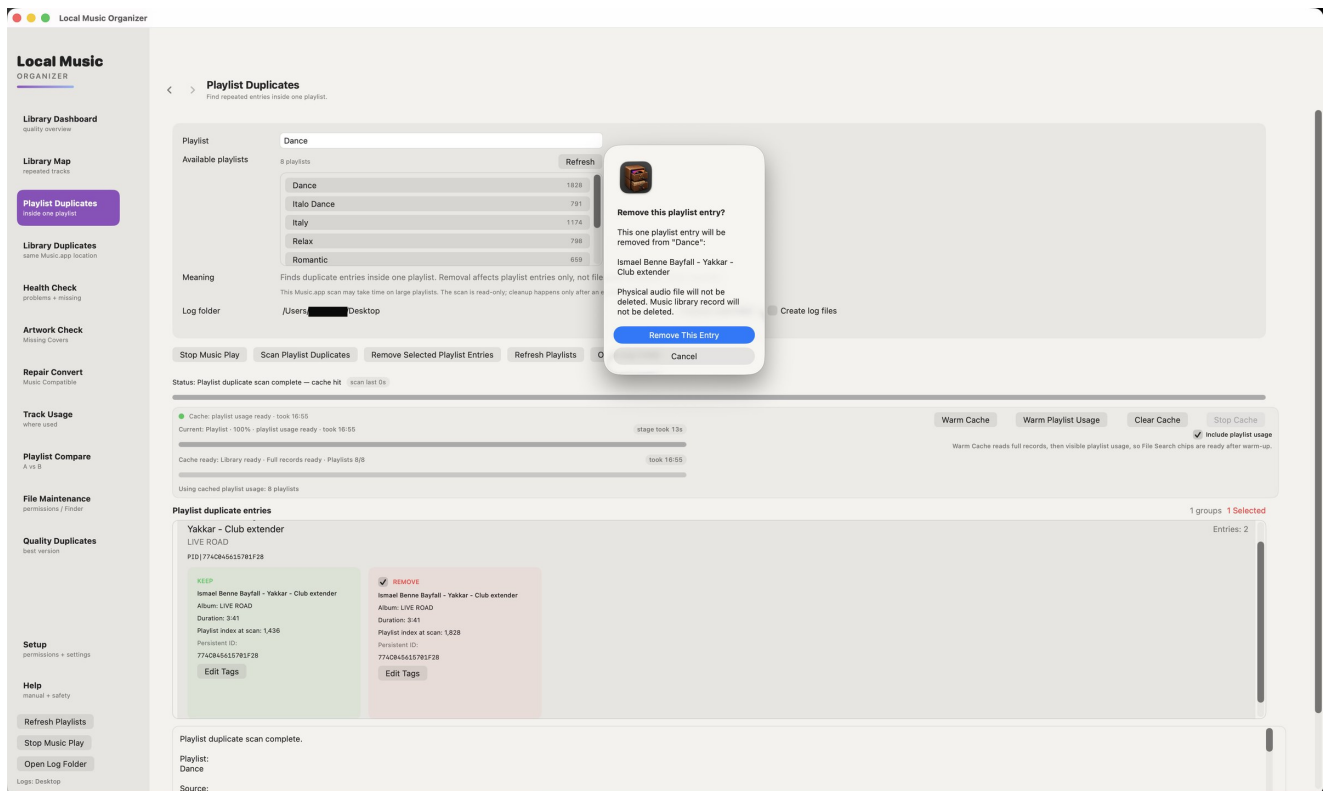


How to use this section

- The source playlist remains the scope of the scan.
- Compare title, artist, duration and file location before choosing an entry.
- Use Play in Music when two entries appear similar.
- Removal affects only the selected playlist entry.

Playlist duplicate cleanup

Actions remain explicit and reviewable.

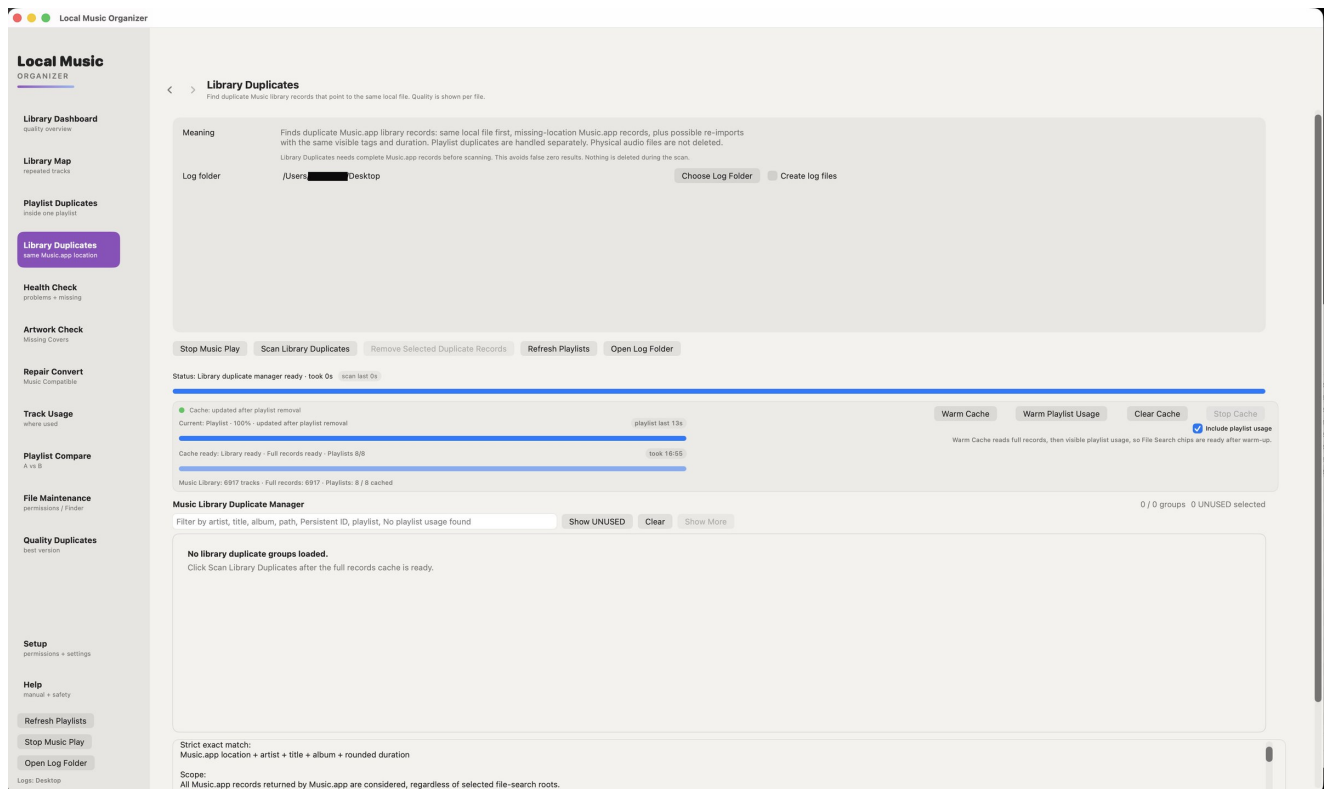


How to use this section

- Select only confirmed duplicate entries.
- Use Undo Last Change immediately after an incorrect reversible action.
- Refresh the results after cleanup.
- Keep a backup before bulk playlist maintenance.

Library Duplicates

Finds Music.app records that may refer to the same file or duplicate content.

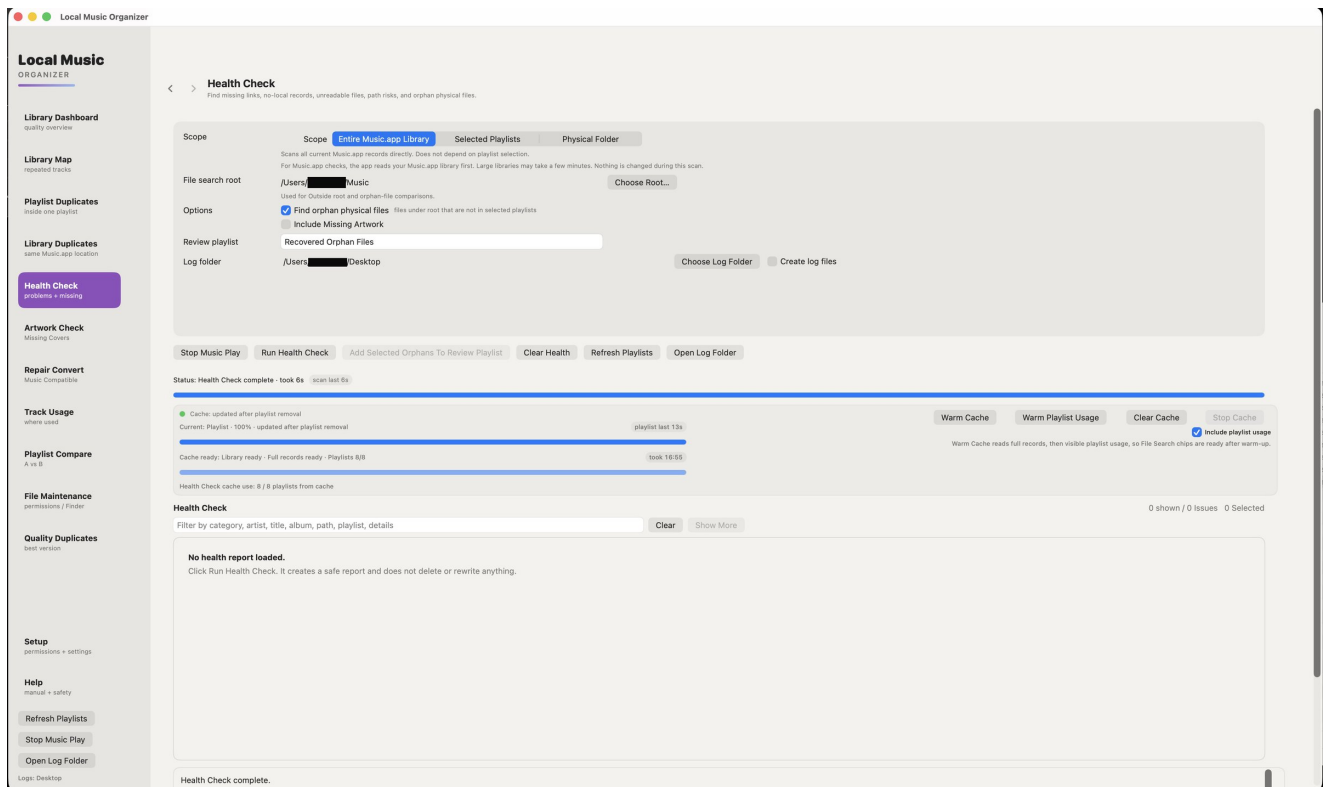


How to use this section

- Warm full records and playlist usage first.
- Distinguish a duplicate Music.app record from a second physical file.
- Protect records used by playlists.
- Preview and reveal candidates before removing any library record.

Health Check

Read-only diagnostics for records, selected playlists or a physical folder.

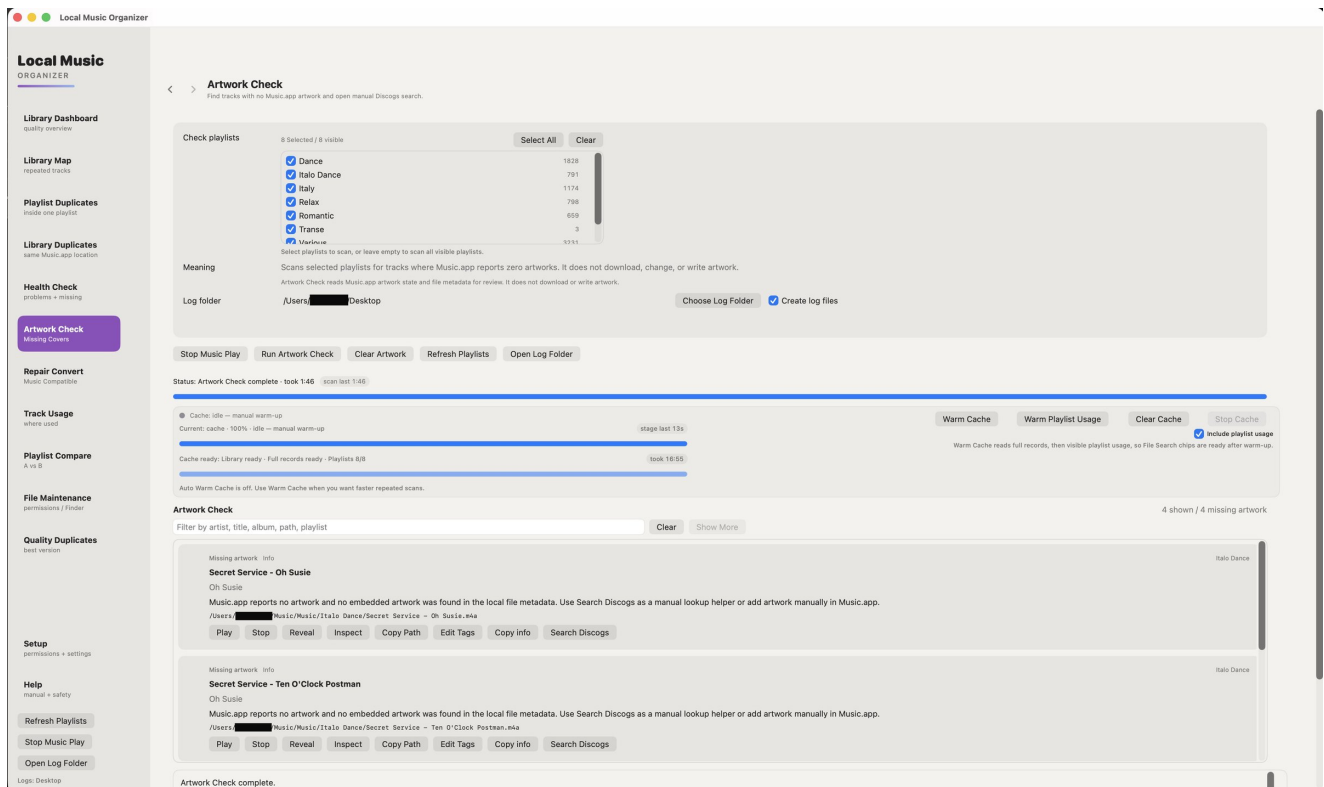


How to use this section

- Choose the scope carefully before starting.
- Review missing files, inaccessible paths and metadata problems.
- A warning is diagnostic information, not permission to delete.
- Use File Maintenance only when a physical-file action is actually needed.

Artwork Check

A separate artwork-focused scan.

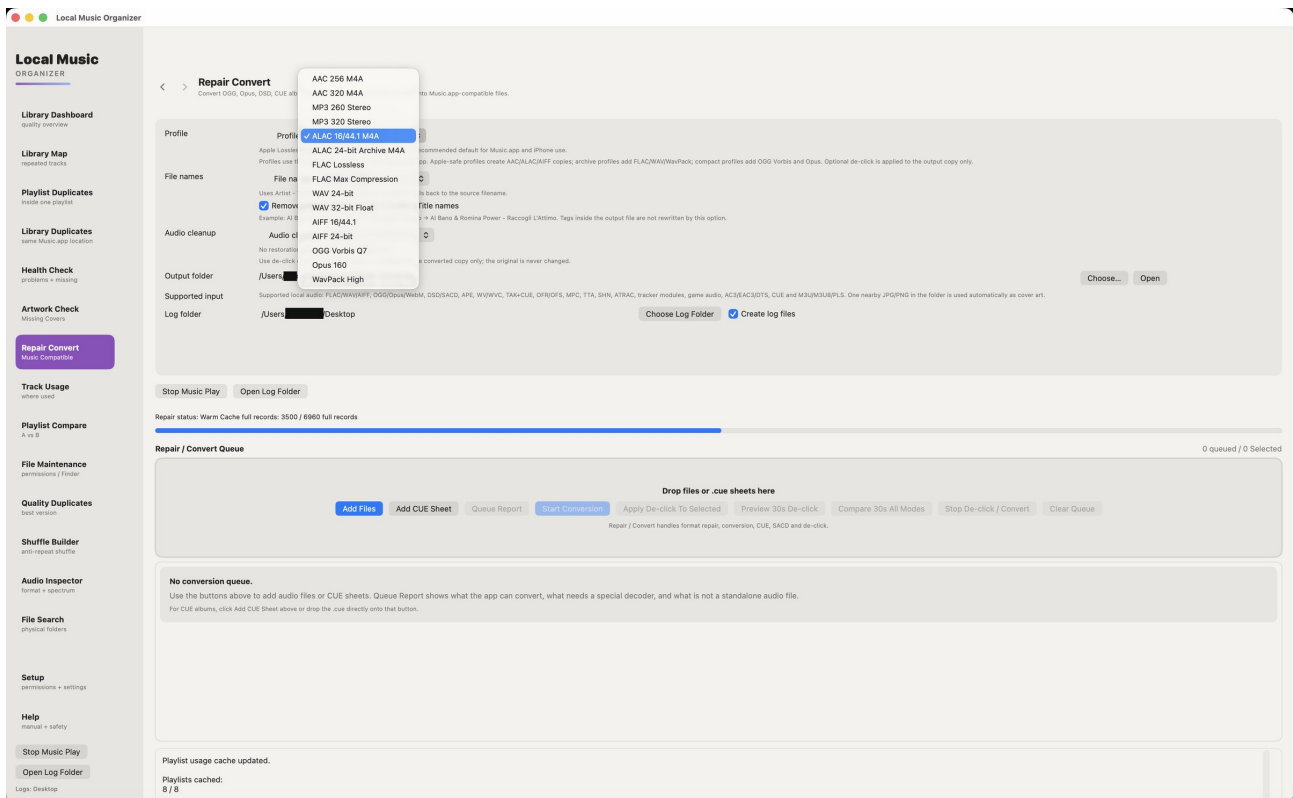


How to use this section

- Artwork access through Music.app can be slower than light metadata checks.
- The scan finds missing covers but does not modify images.
- Review album grouping before deciding that artwork is missing.
- Add or replace artwork manually only after confirmation.

Repair / Convert queue

Add audio files, playlists or CUE sheets and inspect detected sources.

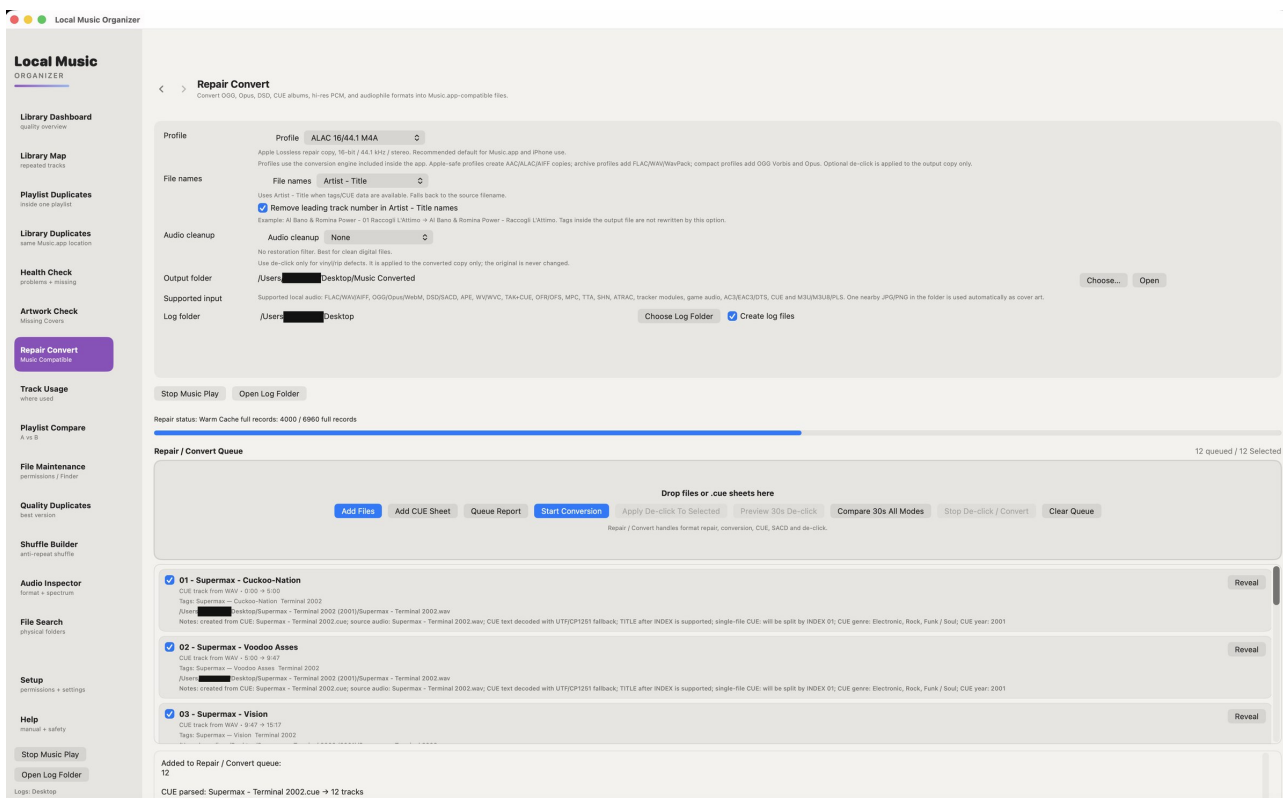


How to use this section

- Repair / Convert does not need the Music.app cache.
- Choose an output folder when macOS asks.
- Analyze the queue before conversion when source details are uncertain.
- Ordinary conversion creates new output files.

Built-in conversion engines

All required engines are included in the application.

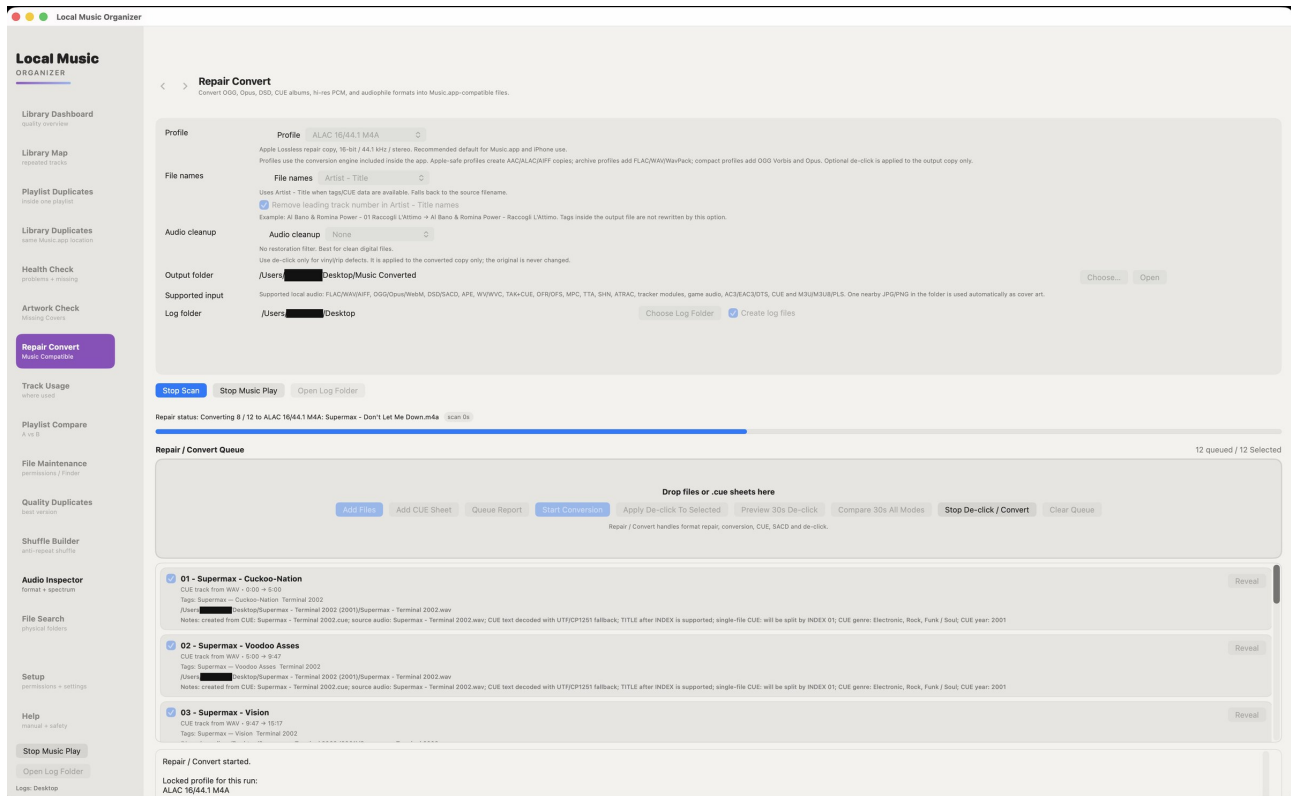


How to use this section

- Do not install separate codecs, Terminal tools or Homebrew.
- Choose a profile appropriate for Music.app or archival use.
- A listed extension can still fail if the source is damaged or non-standard.
- Read the queue report when a conversion is skipped.

Conversion profiles and progress

Progress represents the active decoding and encoding stages.



How to use this section

- Long lossless, DSD or ISO sources can take substantial time.
- Stopping should prevent an incomplete result from being presented as finished.
- Listen to the output and inspect tags before importing it into Music.app.
- Keep the original source until the result is verified.

Playlist Compare

Compares two selected playlists using several matching levels.

The screenshot shows the 'Local Music Organizer' application with the 'Playlist Compare' section active. The interface is divided into a left sidebar and a main content area.

Left Sidebar (Local Music Organizer):

- Local Music ORGANIZER**
- Library Dashboard** (Quality preview)
- Library Map** (repeated tracks)
- Playlist Duplicates** (make one playlist)
- Library Duplicates** (same Music.app location)
- Health Check** (problems + missing)
- Artwork Check** (missing covers)
- Repair Convert** (Music Compatible)
- Track Usage** (where used)
- Playlist Compare** (A vs B) - **Active**
- File Maintenance** (permissions / Finder)
- Quality Duplicates** (best version)
- Setup** (permissions + settings)
- Help** (manual + safety)
- Refresh Playlists**
- Stop Music Play**
- Open Log Folder**
- Logs:** Desktop

Main Content Area (Playlist Compare):

Playlist Compare
Compare two playlists and show shared or repeated tracks.

Playlist A (Dance):

Track	Count
✓ Dance	1828
Italo Dance	791
Italy	1174
Relax	798
Romantic	659

Playlist B (Italy):

Track	Count
Dance	1828
Italo Dance	791
✓ Italy	1174
Relax	798
Romantic	659

Selected: Dance vs Italy

Log folder: /Users/.../Desktop

Buttons: Stop Music Play, Compare Playlists, Warm Selected Cache, Clear, Refresh Playlists, Open Log Folder

Status: Compare complete (scan last 0s)

Cache: 100% - manual warm-up (stage last 15s)

Cache ready: Library ready - full records ready - Playlists 8/8 (took 16:55)

Auto Warm Cache is off. Use Warm Cache when you want faster repeated scans.

Playlist Compare
Filter by artist, title, album, path, status

Buttons: Show More, Remove All from A, Remove All from B

Bulk removal uses the current filtered compare rows. It removes playlist entries only; audio files and Music library records are not deleted. Undo Last Change can restore them.

Play A	Play B	Stop	Reveal A	Reveal B	Remove from A	Remove from B	Edit A	Edit B	Copy
The Kolers - UN RAGAZZO UNA RAGAZZA Same physical file or same persistent ID appears in both playlists. /Users/.../Music/Music/Dance/The Kolers - UN RAGAZZO UNA RAGAZZA.m4a /Users/.../Music/Music/Dance/The Kolers - UN RAGAZZO UNA RAGAZZA.m4a Repeated in both									
DJ Ötzi - TIROL 2026 Same physical file or same persistent ID appears in both playlists. /Users/.../Music/Music/Dance/DJ Ötzi - TIROL 2026.m4a /Users/.../Music/Music/Dance/DJ Ötzi - TIROL 2026.m4a Repeated in both									

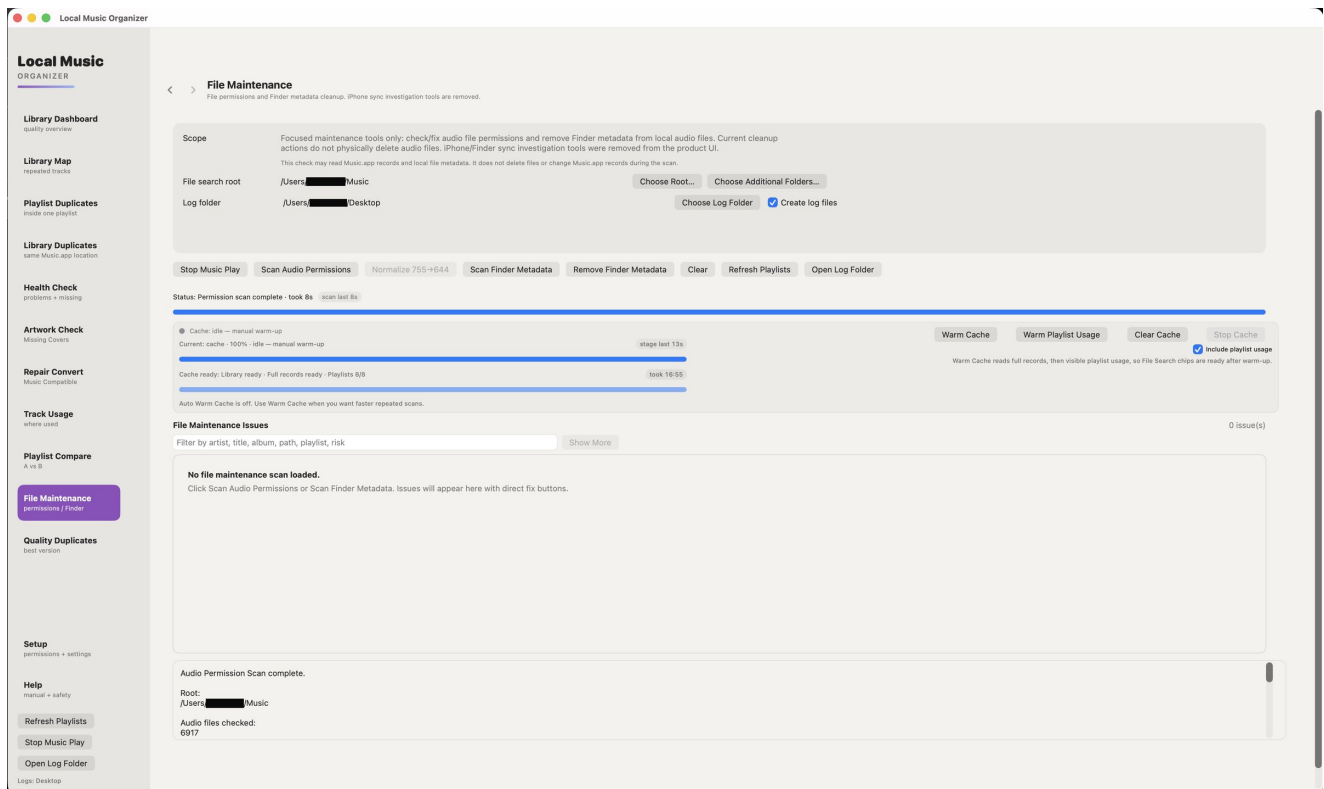
Playlist Compare complete.
Mode: Repeated/shared tracks only. Unique-only tracks are hidden.

How to use this section

- Warm playlist usage first.
- Persistent ID is strongest, followed by exact Music.app location and metadata/duration fallback.
- A possible match requires human review.
- Removing a row affects the chosen playlist entry, not the physical file.

File Maintenance

Physical-file tools for selected folders and explicit actions.

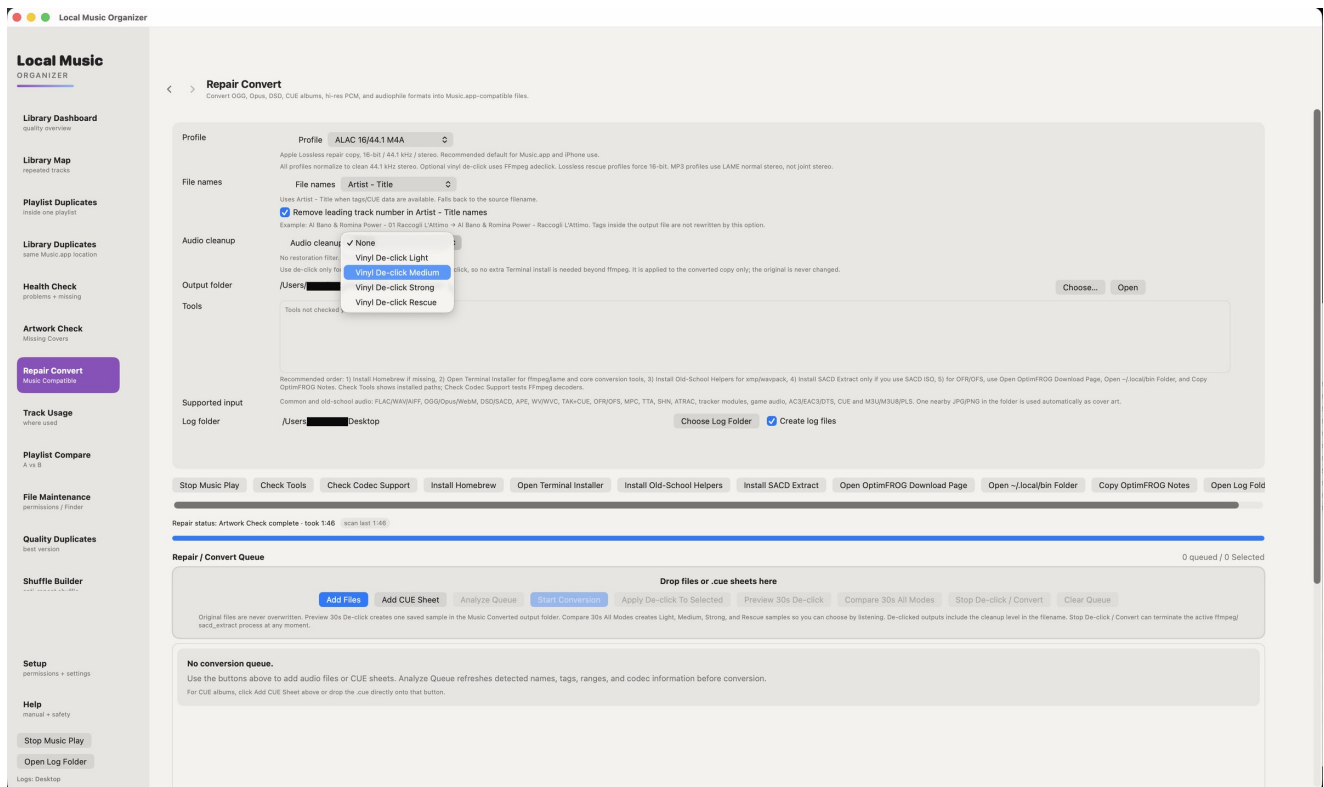


How to use this section

- Choose the folder through the macOS picker.
- Review file paths and permissions before changing them.
- Do not use this section as a substitute for Library Duplicates.
- No Full Disk Access is required.

Vinyl De-click

Preview-first click repair for noisy recordings.

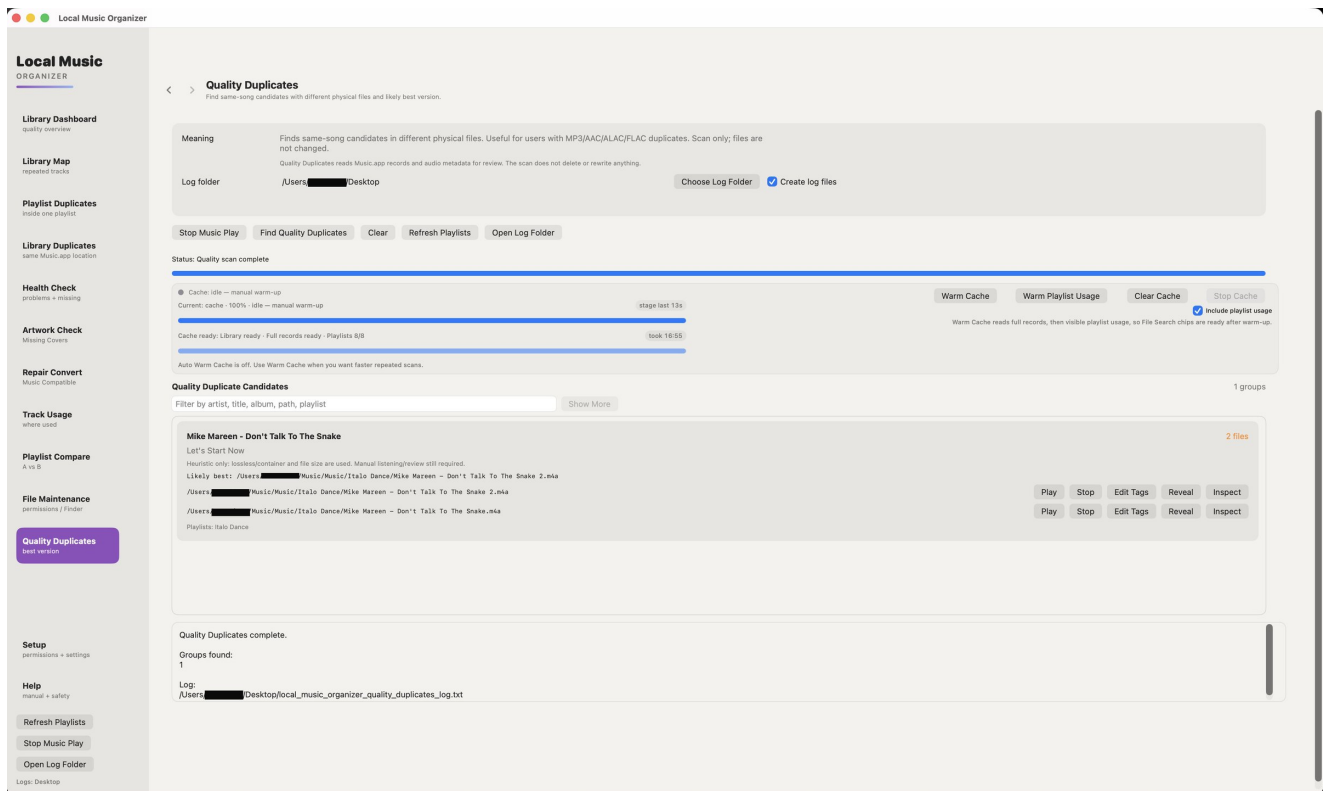


How to use this section

- Create a short comparison sample first.
- Compare Light, Medium, Strong and Rescue when available.
- Choose the weakest mode that removes the click.
- Stronger modes may soften attacks or transients.

Quality Duplicates

Compares likely versions using technical quality signals.

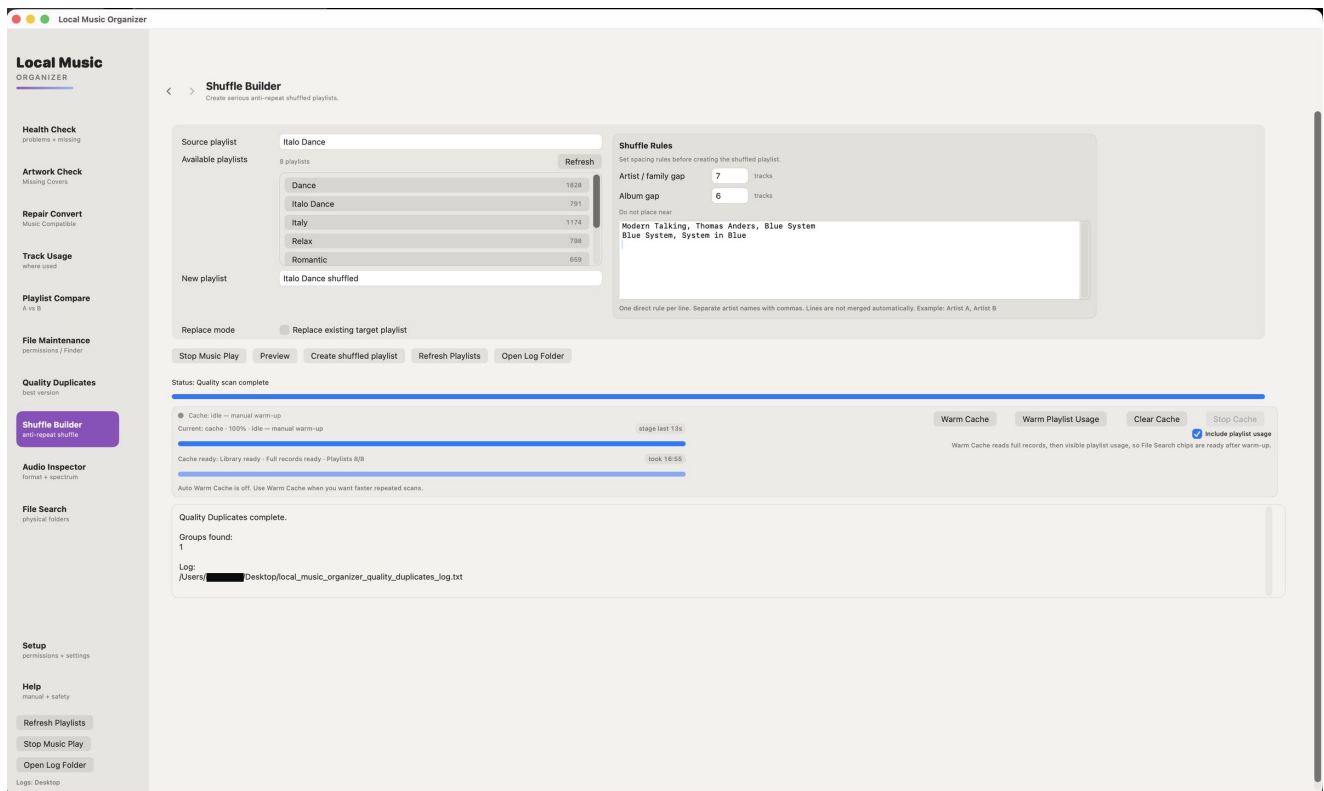


How to use this section

- Codec alone does not determine which master sounds better.
- Compare bitrate, sample rate, duration and file size together.
- Use Audio Inspector and listening before choosing a keeper.
- Preserve rare masters even when another file scores higher technically.

Shuffle Builder

Creates a new anti-repeat playlist from selected sources.



How to use this section

- The source playlists are not modified.
- Preview the source and target counts.
- Store/cloud tracks require a local file location when the workflow needs a file.
- Review the generated playlist in Music.app.

Audio Inspector - lossless

Detailed technical information for a lossless source.

The screenshot shows the 'Audio Inspector' window within the 'Local Music Organizer' application. The interface is divided into a left sidebar and a main content area. The sidebar contains various tool categories: Local Music Organizer, Health Check, Artwork Check, Repair Convert, Track Usage, Playlist Compare, File Maintenance, Quality Duplicates, Shuffle Builder, Audio Inspector (highlighted), File Search, Setup, Help, Refresh Playlists, Stop Music Play, and Open Log Folder. The main content area is titled 'Audio Inspector' and shows the inspection status for a file named 'Dark Side.m4a'. It includes a progress bar for the inspection, which is currently at 100%. Below the progress bar, there are buttons for 'Warm Cache', 'Warm Playlist Usage', 'Clear Cache', and 'Stop Cache'. The 'Warm Playlist Usage' button is checked. The main content area also displays a 'Drop audio file here' section with a list of supported formats: MP3, AAC, M4A, ALAC, WAV, AIFF, FLAC. Below this, there is a table of technical details for the file 'Dark Side.m4a'. The table includes fields for Format, Data format, Source, Family, Bitrate, Sample rate, Bit depth, and Note. The 'Note' field indicates that the file is a LosslessPCM-style file. Below the table is a spectrogram visualization showing frequency (Hz) on the y-axis (0 to 22,000) and amplitude (dB) on the x-axis (-120 to 0). The spectrogram shows a complex waveform with multiple peaks and valleys. The bottom of the window shows the 'Track inspection complete.' status.

Local Music Organizer

Audio Inspector
inspect local audio files and render a spectrum view.

Log folder: /Users/.../Desktop [Choose Log Folder](#) ☒ Create log files

[Stop Music Play](#) [Choose Audio File](#) [Clear Inspector](#) [Refresh Playlists](#) [Open Log Folder](#)

Status: Inspection complete - took 0s [scan last file](#)

Cache: 100% - manual warm-up
Current cache: 100% - 100% - manual warm-up [stage last 13s](#)
Cache ready: Library ready - Full records ready - Playlists 8/8 [took 16:55](#)

Warm Cache Warm Playlist Usage ☒ Clear Cache [Stop Cache](#)
Warm Cache reads full records, then visible playlist usage, so File Search chips are ready after warm-up.

Auto Warm Cache is off. Use Warm Cache when you want faster repeated scans.

Drop audio file here
MP3, AAC, M4A, ALAC, WAV, AIFF, FLAC. Format = bit depth + dB-scale spectrum.
Inspection complete: Yello - Dark Side.m4a
[Choose Audio File](#)

Yello - Dark Side.m4a
Aspect: Music/Music/Relax/Yello - Dark Side.m4a

Format	Data format: 2 ch, 44100 Hz, alac (0x00000001) from 16-bit	Channels	2
Family	Lossless	Duration	4:15
Bitrate	bit rate: 823925 bits per second	File size	26.7 MB
Sample rate	44100 Hz		
Bit depth	16-bit		

Note
LosslessPCM-style file. Bit depth should be meaningful when reported as 16-bit, 24-bit, or 32-bit.

Spectrogram

Hz 22
20
18
16
14
12
10
8
6
4
2
0

0 -120 -100 -80 -60 -40 -20 0

Track inspection complete.

How to use this section

- Review container, codec, channels, sample rate and bit depth.
- Use before conversion or quality duplicate decisions.
- A spectrogram is a visual aid, not proof of mastering quality.
- Return to the originating tool with Back.

Audio Inspector - lossy

Technical inspection for compressed audio.

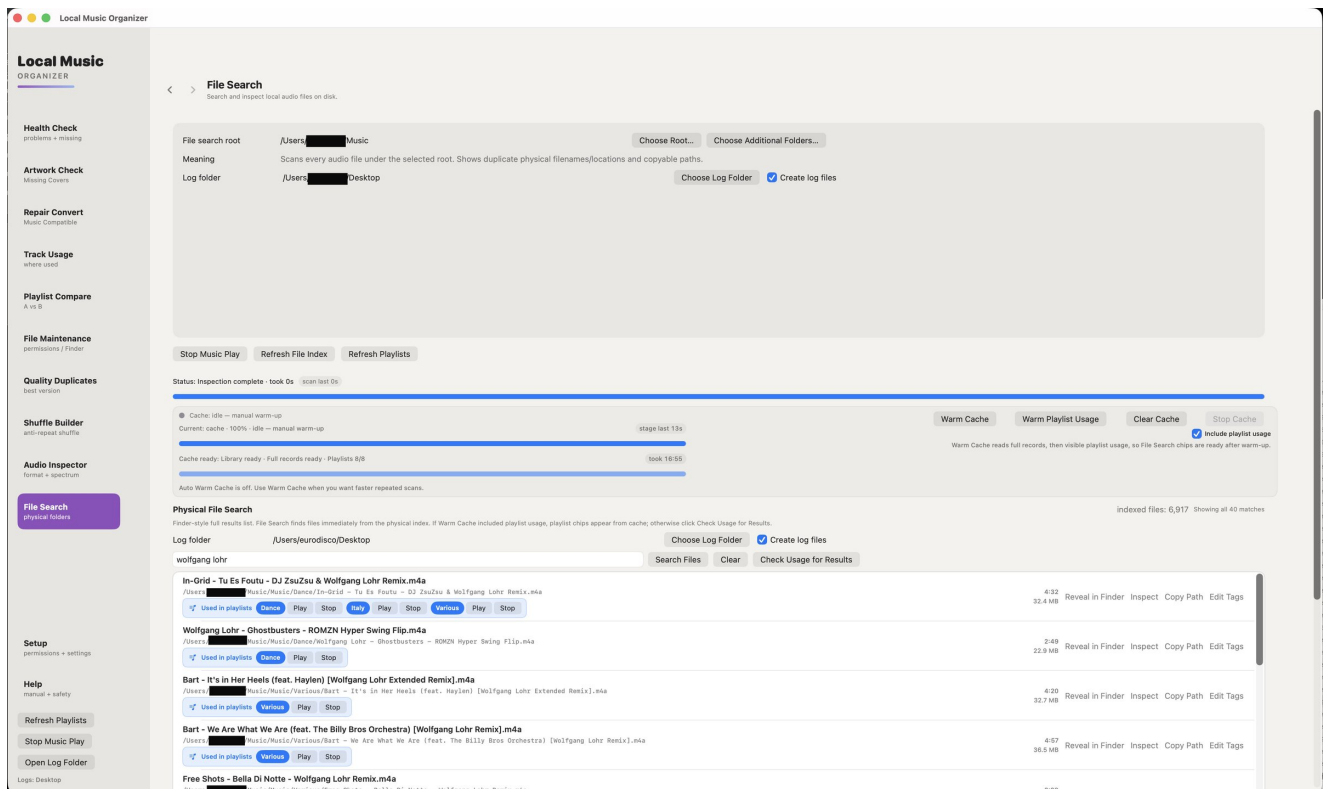
The screenshot shows the 'Audio Inspector' window within the 'Local Music Organizer' application. The interface is divided into a left sidebar and a main content area. The sidebar contains various tool categories: Local Music Organizer, Health Check, Artwork Check, Repair Convert, Track Usage, Playlist Compare, File Maintenance, Quality Duplicates, Shuffle Builder, Audio Inspector (highlighted), File Search, Setup, Help, Refresh Playlists, Stop Music Play, and Open Log Folder. The main content area is titled 'Audio Inspector' and includes a 'Log folder' field set to '/Users/[redacted]/Desktop'. Below this are buttons for 'Stop Music Play', 'Choose Audio File', 'Clear Inspector', 'Refresh Playlists', and 'Open Log Folder'. A status bar indicates 'Inspection complete - took 0s'. A progress bar shows 'Cache: 100% - full - manual warm-up'. A table displays 'Cache ready: Library ready - Full records ready - Playlists 8/8' and 'took 16:05'. A 'Drop audio file here' section provides instructions for supported formats (MP3, AAC, M4A, ALAC, WAV, AIFF, FLAC) and a 'Choose Audio File' button. The selected file is 'Jerry Ropero Pres. Mm Feat. Don Teco - Te Toca Shake Ur Body.mp3'. A table shows file details: Format (Data format: 2 ch, 44100 Hz, mp3 (0x00000000) 0 bits/channel, 0 bytes/packet, 1152 frames/packet, 0 bytes/frame), Family (Lossy), Bitrate (bit rate: 320000 bits per second), Sample rate (44100 Hz), and Bit depth (N/A for MP3/AAC lossy). A 'Spectrogram' visualization shows frequency (0-22 kHz) over time. A 'Track inspection complete.' message is at the bottom.

How to use this section

- Review bitrate and codec together.
- Check duration and channel layout for unexpected changes.
- Use listening and provenance alongside technical values.
- Do not assume a larger file is automatically better.

File Search and Track Usage

Searches indexed physical files and connects them to Music.app usage.



How to use this section

- Warm full records and playlist usage for the fastest complete results.
- Use Check Usage for Results when playlist usage was not warmed.
- Click the bright-blue playlist name to open that playlist and reveal the exact track.
- Each playlist button is independent when the file appears in several playlists.

Specialist formats and CUE albums

Common and audiophile sources

FLAC, ALAC, WAV, AIFF, AAC/M4A, MP3, Ogg Vorbis, Opus, WavPack/WVC, APE, TAK, TTA, SHN, DSF, DFF, DSD, SACD ISO, DTS, AC3/E-AC3, CUE sheets and tracker modules.

Output profiles

AAC, ALAC, MP3, FLAC, WAV, AIFF, Ogg Vorbis, Opus and WavPack.

CUE sheets

- A single-file CUE can split one source by INDEX positions.
- A multi-file CUE can create output from several referenced sources.
- Review track titles and source paths before conversion.
- Keep the CUE and original audio together until output is verified.

SACD ISO and DSD

- The application reads the SACD table of contents and can expose stereo tracks.
- Large ISO extraction can be slow and requires enough free output space.
- Keep the original ISO until every output track is checked.

Compatibility

Corrupted, encrypted, mislabeled or unusual sources may fail even when the extension is normally supported. The queue report is the first place to look for the exact cause.

Troubleshooting

A library tool is slow

- Confirm that Warm Cache completed.
- Include playlist usage when the tool depends on playlist relationships.
- The first warm-up can be long; later work should be much faster.
- Do not clear a healthy cache before every scan.

Results appear outdated

- Refresh Playlists.
- Clear and warm the cache again after large external Music.app changes.
- Reconnect an external disk and reselect a moved folder.

Conversion stops or rolls back

- Confirm the output folder is still permitted and writable.
- Confirm sufficient free space.
- Read the queue report for the actual decoder or verification error.
- Try a small known-good file with the same output profile.
- Preserve the original; a failed conversion must not be treated as complete.

Music.app did not open the expected track

- Wait briefly for Music.app to finish selecting the playlist and track.
- Use the individual bright-blue playlist button, not the surrounding usage area.
- Refresh playlists and warm playlist usage if the relationship is outdated.

Privacy, open source and support

Privacy

The application does not collect personal data, analytics, diagnostics, advertising identifiers or usage history. Audio, metadata, artwork, playlists, caches and logs remain on the user Mac.

Open source

Bundled components include FFmpeg/FFprobe, LAME, WavPack, DSD Nexus and libopenmpt. License notices and available source materials are included with the application and published on the website.

Support

Email: sergeyappleservice@gmail.com

Website: <https://local-music-organizer-site.pages.dev/>

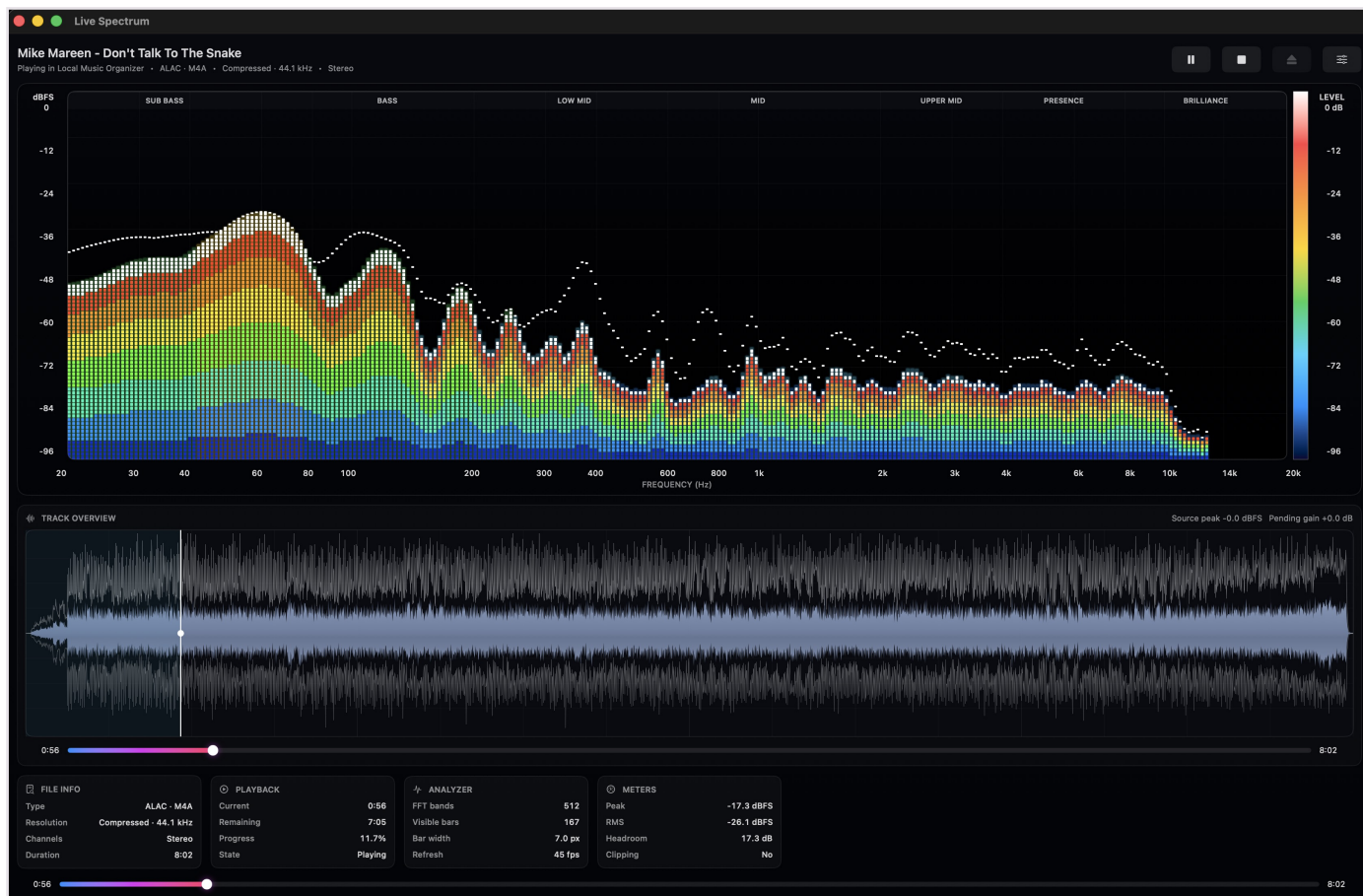
Privacy: <https://local-music-organizer-site.pages.dev/privacy.html>

Open source: <https://local-music-organizer-site.pages.dev/open-source.html>

Keep this guide with the release build. Interface details may change in later updates.

Live Spectrum and local player

Real-time analysis, full-track overview and technical playback data



Screenshot 21 - Live Spectrum with the full-track waveform, playback data and technical meters.

What the Live Spectrum window shows

- Local playback and analysis run inside Local Music Organizer without creating another Music.app record.
- The logarithmic analyzer displays sub-bass, bass, low mid, mid, upper mid, presence and brilliance regions, with a dBFS scale and peak trace.
- The analyzer uses 512 FFT bands and reports the current visible-bar count, selected bar width and refresh rate.
- Technical cards show file type, resolution, channels, duration, current time, remaining time, progress, peak, RMS, headroom and clipping state.
- The full-track waveform keeps short transients visible and shows the current playback cursor across the complete file.

Player controls, seeking and window behavior

Clear transport logic and an independent macOS player window

Playback controls

- Play starts the loaded track. Pause keeps the current position, and Play continues from the same point.
- Stop is a true stop: the audio engine stops and the position returns to 0:00. The loaded track and already-built waveform remain visible, so Play starts the same track from the beginning without rebuilding the overview.
- Eject removes the loaded track and clears the player. Use Eject only when the player should become empty.
- Click anywhere in the waveform to jump to that position. Drag across the waveform for continuous seeking. The lower progress bar is also draggable.
- Seeking works during playback and while paused. During dragging, the displayed time follows the proposed position before the final seek is committed.

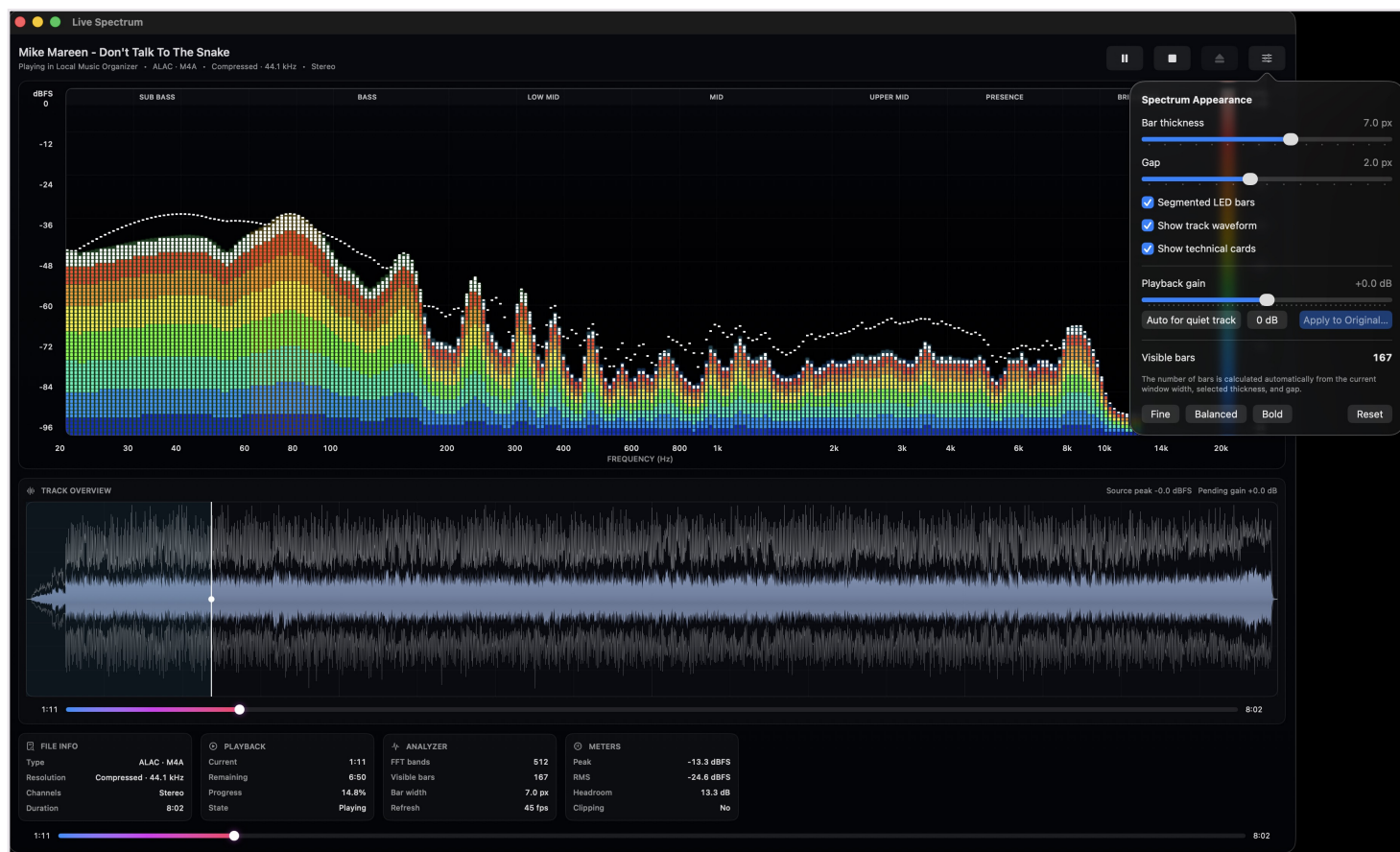
Independent macOS window

- The yellow window button minimizes Live Spectrum into the Dock.
- The red window button closes and hides the player window, but playback continues.
- When music is playing and the player is hidden, click the Local Music Organizer icon in the Dock to restore it.
- The player and the main organizer window are independent. Clicking the player does not intentionally bring the main organizer window to the front.
- Background conversion and gain processing do not intentionally close unrelated Finder folders or other organizer windows.

Normal macOS window meaning is preserved: yellow minimizes; red hides. Playback ends only after Pause, Stop, Eject, another playback command, or natural completion.

Spectrum appearance and playback gain

Customize the analyzer, preview gain and apply a verified change



Screenshot 22 - Spectrum Appearance controls and the playback-gain workflow.

Appearance controls

- Adjust bar thickness and gap, enable or disable segmented LED bars, and show or hide the waveform and technical cards.
- Fine, Balanced and Bold presets provide quick starting points. Reset restores the standard display.
- The visible bar count is calculated automatically from the current window width, selected bar thickness and gap.

Gain preview and Apply to Original File

- Playback gain can be previewed from -12 dB to +12 dB without immediately rewriting the source file. The waveform expands or contracts around its zero line to show the selected gain visually.
- Auto for quiet track provides a conservative preview increase. 0 dB returns playback to the source level.
- Apply to Original File creates a temporary candidate and verifies it before replacement. The workflow preserves the source codec family, sample rate, channel count and bit depth where supported.
- Embedded artwork is verified separately by SHA-256. Metadata, chapters and meaningful media streams are checked before replacement. If verification fails, the original remains or is restored from the rollback copy.
- A diagnostic gain-operation log records stages, the FFmpeg command, heartbeat, progress, verification results and the exact failure reason.

Drag-and-drop conversion

Send files from Finder directly to Repair / Convert or Audio Inspector

Repair / Convert drop area

- Drag one file or several files into the large Repair / Convert drop area to add them to the conversion queue.
- Drag a .cue sheet into the drop area or directly onto Add CUE Sheet. For a CUE album, macOS may ask once for access to the folder containing both the CUE and its referenced audio file. That folder permission is saved for later CUE files inside the same authorized root.
- Use Add Files and Add CUE Sheet when a system file picker is preferable. Analyze Queue reports the detected format, the engine that can handle it, special-decoder requirements and sources that are not standalone audio files.
- Select only the queue items to process, choose the output profile, then run Convert Selected. Clear Queue removes pending entries without changing the source files.
- Ordinary Repair / Convert writes new output files and does not require the Music.app cache.

Drop onto the application icon

- Drag local audio files or CUE sheets from Finder onto the Local Music Organizer application icon. Multiple file-open events are grouped into one batch.
- A normal application-icon drop adds only those dropped files to the queue and starts conversion automatically using the currently selected Repair / Convert profile.
- Hold Option while dropping a file onto the application icon to open it in Audio Inspector instead of converting it. When several files are dropped with Option, the first file is opened for full inspection.
- Finder/Dock drop processing runs without intentionally bringing the main organizer window to the front and without closing the Finder folder that contains the source track.
- Direct Finder/Dock conversion retains the sandbox permission supplied with the dropped file for the complete background operation.

Before dropping files for automatic conversion, confirm the active output profile and output folder. The drop command uses the current Repair / Convert settings.

Conversion, inspection and file safety

What happens before, during and after a conversion

Conversion workflow

- Repair / Convert supports common formats and specialist sources including CUE albums, TAK, SACD ISO, DSD, DTS, AC3/E-AC3, tracker modules and other formats listed in the application.
- The bundled offline engines are used inside the sandbox. Separate Terminal tools or Homebrew are not required.
- Queue analysis is recommended when source details are uncertain. A listed extension can still fail if the source is damaged, encrypted, incomplete or non-standard.
- Progress reflects active decoding and encoding. Long lossless, DSD, ISO or multi-track CUE sources can require substantial time.
- Stop De-click / Convert requests cancellation and prevents an incomplete output from being presented as a completed result. Always listen to and inspect the output before importing it into Music.app.

Audio Inspector and local preview

- Audio Inspector reads technical properties such as format, codec, sample rate, bitrate, bit depth where available, channel layout and duration.
- Local playback can open Live Spectrum so the physical file can be heard and analyzed without creating another Music.app library record.
- The spectrum and waveform are useful for checking unusual files before conversion, comparing outputs and locating audible problems in a recording.
- Reveal in Finder locates the physical source. Finder Preview or Quick Look provides an additional independent check.

Explicit actions and original protection

- Read-only tools do not modify files. Playlist-entry removal affects the selected Music.app playlist entry, not the physical audio file.
- Ordinary conversion writes a new result. Applying gain to the original is a separate confirmed operation with a temporary candidate, verification and rollback.
- Keep a current backup before maintenance, and keep the original source until every converted output has been verified.

Cache refresh rules

Rebuild cached library data whenever Music.app content changes

After every addition of tracks to Music.app or removal of tracks from Music.app, click Refresh Playlists and warm the cache again before relying on library-wide results.

Required workflow after adding or removing tracks

1. Finish the import, addition, removal, record cleanup or playlist change in Music.app or Local Music Organizer.
2. Click Refresh Playlists so the current playlist list and track counts are read again.
3. Run Warm Cache to rebuild Full Library Records.
4. Warm Playlist Usage whenever playlist membership, File Search labels, Track Usage, Playlist Compare, Library Map, Playlist Duplicates or duplicate protection must reflect the current library.
5. Wait until the relevant cache indicators show Ready before treating the results as current.

Why this is mandatory

- The saved cache is a snapshot. It cannot automatically know that Music.app tracks or playlist memberships changed after the snapshot was created.
- Using stale cache data can produce outdated duplicate groups, playlist membership, artwork counts, missing-file status, Track Usage results or File Search labels.
- Rebuild after every track addition or deletion. Also rebuild after substantial playlist edits, replacing or moving many files, changing disks or mount points, or whenever displayed results no longer match Music.app.
- Do not repeatedly clear a healthy cache when the library has not changed. Cache reuse is intentional and makes large-library tools much faster.

Metadata and artwork protection

Narrow cleanup rules, SHA-256 verification and rollback

Hidden embedded metadata cleanup

- The cleanup targets only explicitly selected removable fields such as copyright, license/licence, publisher, label and downloader/source URL metadata.
- It preserves artwork, title, artist, album, lyrics, grouping, handler_name, language, vendor_id, iTunSMPB and technical/container metadata. Encoder metadata is preserved unless a specific remux operation regenerates it.
- When embedded artwork exists, its image bytes are hashed before cleanup. The candidate and final committed file must contain byte-identical artwork with the same SHA-256 value.
- If artwork extraction, hashing, restoration, tag verification or final replacement fails, the exact rollback copy is restored and the failure is recorded in a per-file diagnostic log.

Extended attributes

- The narrowly scoped recopy cleanup removes only com.apple.lastuseddate#PS.
- Quarantine, FinderInfo, macl, Finder tags and other extended attributes are preserved unless a separate explicit tool states otherwise.
- The application does not treat diagnostic warnings as permission to perform broad metadata removal.

Artwork Check is report-only: it finds missing covers but does not download, create or write artwork. Add or replace missing artwork manually only after confirming the correct album grouping.